04-03 第1篇

阅读理解（记叙文） Cooking Dinner for Mum on Her Birthday

① Mum's birthday falls on 3 April. This year, for the first time, I decided to cook dinner for her **all by myself**. I am 14, and I had made instant noodles before, but a real dinner with three dishes felt like climbing a small mountain. I did not tell Mum anything. I wanted it to be a **true surprise**, even if the food looked a little strange.

② A week before the big day, I opened Grandma's cookbook and chose three easy dishes: **egg-and-tomato soup**, **stir-fried green beans**, and **soy-sauce chicken wings**. Mum loves these three; they live in our kitchen like quiet old friends. On Saturday morning, Dad and I went to the market. He stood back and let me choose everything: six tomatoes with sun-warm skin, a small bag of green beans, and eight wings that still looked a little shy in the paper bag.

③ The real trouble came in the afternoon. When I tried to light the gas stove, the flame **jumped up loud and blue**, and I jumped back even louder. Dad only said, "Breathe first. Stove after." After two tries, I managed it. My tomato soup turned out fine — red, bright, and honest. But the green beans burned a little on one side because I forgot to stir them. "Burnt beans mean a brave cook," Dad whispered. I laughed, though my heart felt heavy.

④ The chicken wings were the biggest test. The recipe said "**turn the wings every three minutes**", but I kept staring at my phone, waiting for messages from my best friend. When I looked down, one side of the wings was almost black. My eyes stung. I wanted to throw the whole pan out of the window. Dad saw my face and said quietly, "Cut the black edges. Put them back with more soy sauce. A small mistake is not the end of dinner."

⑤ At six o'clock, Mum came home. The kitchen was warm, a little smoky, and smelled like a small restaurant. I had set the table with a paper flower I made at school. Mum froze at the door. Her eyes became wet in a second. "Xiaoyu, did you do all this?" I nodded, suddenly shy. "Happy birthday, Mum. The beans are a bit… toasted. The wings are a bit… sun-tanned. But the love inside is just right."

⑥ We sat down to eat. To my surprise, the soup was Mum's favourite bite of the evening. She said it reminded her of Grandma's soup, the one she drank when she was my age. The green beans, burnt edges and all, disappeared faster than I thought. The wings were not restaurant-perfect, but Mum ate three and kept saying they had "**a special kitchen-smell of home**".

⑦ After dinner, while washing the dishes, I realised something. **Cooking is not only about food.** It is also about standing in front of a loud stove without running away, turning small mistakes into soy-sauce second chances, and finally putting a plate in front of someone who loves you. Next year, I will do better. But I will always remember this imperfect birthday dinner — the first one I made with my own two, slightly shaking, hands.

根据文章内容，选择最佳答案。

1. What did the writer plan to do for Mum's birthday?

A. Buy her a gold necklace.
B. Cook dinner by himself as a surprise.
C. Take her to a famous restaurant.
D. Write her a long poem.

2. Why were the green beans burnt on one side?

A. The writer used too much oil.
B. The writer forgot to stir them.
C. The beans were too old.
D. The stove broke down.

3. What did Dad say when the chicken wings went wrong?

A. "Let's give up and order takeaway."
B. "Throw them out of the window."
C. "Cut the black edges and add more soy sauce — a small mistake is not the end."
D. "Call Grandma right now."

4. Which dish did Mum like BEST on the birthday table?

A. The stir-fried green beans.
B. The soy-sauce chicken wings.
C. The egg-and-tomato soup.
D. The paper flower.

5. What lesson did the writer learn from cooking dinner?

A. Cooking is only about the food on the plate.
B. Phones must always stay next to the stove.
C. Cooking also teaches us to face mistakes and show love.
D. Restaurants are always better than home meals.

答案与解析

1.
【答案】B
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第①段 "cook dinner for her all by myself... a true surprise"
【解析】打算独自做饭作为生日惊喜。故选 B。

2.
【答案】B
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第③段 "I forgot to stir them"
【解析】忘了翻炒，故烧焦。故选 B。

3.
【答案】C
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第④段 "Cut the black edges. Put them back with more soy sauce"
【解析】切掉焦边再加酱油救回。故选 C。

4.
【答案】C
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第⑥段 "the soup was Mum's favourite bite of the evening"
【解析】妈妈最爱番茄蛋汤。故选 C。

5.
【答案】C
【题型】主旨归纳题
【定位】第⑦段 "Cooking is not only about food... facing mistakes... showing love"
【解析】做饭也是面对错误与表达爱意。故选 C。

词汇注释（超纲词）

- **stove** [n.] 灶台
- **soy sauce** [n.] 酱油
- **cookbook** [n.] 食谱